major issue, which form of governance and security control will ensure that Hamas won't be able to reappear in Gaza and become a threat once more?

The last question is of course the most difficult one. There will be debates about the composition of an international controlling force to be stationed in the enclave, about the width of a demilitarized zone between Israel and Gaza, etc. The main issue will be that of the long-term political future of the enclave, together with the West Bank. The answer will depend on the government of Israel existing at that time.

The present coalition will oppose any solution that includes, eventually, a Palestinian state, even if it means a clash with the United States. But the coalition may be doomed at the war's end. Netanyahu is held responsible for October 7 and many previous mistakes, and there is a good chance that he will be swept out of power. Last July, in my concluding note to the first part of this diary, I mentioned that a Gantz-Lapid coalition was not obvious, given the personal hostility between them, but now a Gantz-Eisenkot government could be on the cards. Whether a government like that would accept the idea of a Palestinian state is not certain either. It may possibly accept one as a long-term project. To my mind, as I have repeatedly stated here, this is the only long-term solution that has a chance to hold and to ensure peace and security for all.

Actually, I am only imagining the optimistic outcome. In this conflict, one cannot unfortunately avoid looking also at the other possibility. Even if (and this is a big "if") a future Israel government were to accept the idea of a Palestinian state, one cannot exclude a refusal by the Palestinians to accept the presence of a Jewish state on their land. This was Moshe Dayan's vision of the future which, it will be remembered, he expressed in his speech at the tomb of a friend killed by Palestinian infiltrators from Gaza, in the early 1950s, and which he repeated to me in our conversation in 1966, as I mentioned in the first part of this diary. Over the years, the Palestinian "refusal front" has become militarily stronger, particularly with